TITLE 2 THEME 2 CHILD EDITION

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THE BURNING BUSH AND THE BIG WRESTLING MATCH

A Fun Look at God in the Old Testament

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A Note for Parents

The Old Testament has some wild stories. A bush that burns but never turns to ash. A man who wrestles with a stranger all night long. A donkey that talks. A sea that splits in half. A boy who fights a giant. A king who hides in a cave.

These stories are exciting. They are strange. They are fun. And here is the secret. They are all clues. Every one of them points to one person. That person is Jesus.

This book is a 30 day adventure for you and your kids. Each day has a secret clue. Each day has a big reveal. Each day has a fun family activity. Each day has a simple prayer. Each day has a coloring prompt. You do not need to be a Bible expert to lead this. You just need a little imagination. Get ready to burn a bush. Get ready to wrestle. Get ready to find Jesus.

How to Use This Book

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the secret clue. Read the big reveal. Do the family activity together. Say the prayer out loud. Let your child color the picture or do the coloring prompt. The goal is not perfection. The goal is connection. Have fun with it. Get messy. Ask questions. Laugh together. This is an adventure. Let us begin.

Day 01: The Bush on Fire

The Secret Clue

"There the angel of the LORD appeared to him in flames of fire from within a bush. Moses saw that though the bush was on fire it did not burn up." - Exodus 3:2

Moses was walking in the desert. He saw a bush. The bush was on fire. Flames were everywhere. But the bush did not burn up. It stayed green. It stayed whole. Moses walked closer. And a voice came from the bush. It was God.

That is a strange clue. A bush on fire that does not burn? Yes. God was in the fire. God was in the bush. He was there.

The Big Reveal

"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son." - John 1:14

The burning bush was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. God was in a bush. God came in a body. The fire did not destroy the bush. The grave did not destroy Jesus. God comes close. He does not burn us up. He fills us.

Family Activity

Make a "burning bush" with red, orange, and yellow tissue paper. Crumple the tissue paper into small balls. Glue them onto a drawing of a bush. Talk about how the fire did not burn the bush. Talk about how God was in the fire. Talk about how God is with us.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for the burning bush. Thank you that your fire does not burn me up. Thank you for being with me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A green bush with bright flames on it and a smiling face in the fire.

Day 02: The Big Wrestling Match

The Secret Clue

"So Jacob was left alone, and a man wrestled with him till daybreak... Then the man said, 'Your name will no longer be Jacob, but Israel, because you have struggled with God and with humans and have overcome.'" - Genesis 32:24, 28

Jacob was alone. He was scared. And a man came. And they wrestled. All night. In the dark. In the dirt. And Jacob would not let go. The man was God. Jacob wrestled with God. And he got a blessing. And a new name.

That is a strange clue. God wrestled? Like a person? Yes. He let Jacob grab Him. He let Jacob hold on. He let Jacob wrestle with Him.

The Big Reveal

"Jesus let himself be grabbed, beaten, and held on a cross. He did not break free. He let himself be held. For us." - Hebrews 2:9

The big wrestling match was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus let Himself be grabbed. He let Himself be held. He let Himself be hurt. He did not break free. He did it for us. He lets us hold on to Him.

Family Activity

Have a gentle wrestling match on a soft rug or bed. Let your child hold on to your arm and say, "I will not let go." Talk about how Jacob held on to God. Talk about how we can hold on to God too. Be safe. Be gentle. Have fun.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for letting me hold on to you. Thank you for being strong. Thank you for blessing me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

Two people holding on to each other with a big heart between them.

Day 03: The Ladder to the Sky

The Secret Clue

"He had a dream in which he saw a stairway resting on the earth, with its top reaching to heaven, and the angels of God were ascending and descending on it." - Genesis 28:12

Jacob was running away. He was scared. He fell asleep. And he dreamed. He saw a ladder. It reached from earth to heaven. Angels were going up and down. And God was at the top. God was there. In the dream. At the top of the ladder.

That is a strange clue. A ladder to heaven? Angels on it? What does it mean?

The Big Reveal

"He then added, 'Very truly I tell you, you will see heaven open, and the angels of God ascending and descending on the Son of Man.'" - John 1:51

The ladder was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the ladder. He is the stairway. He connects heaven and earth. He connects us to God. He is the way. He is the bridge.

Family Activity

Build a ladder with blocks or pillows. Or draw a big ladder on paper. Put a star at the top for God. Talk about how the ladder goes up to heaven. Talk about how Jesus is our ladder. He connects us to God.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being the ladder. Thank you for connecting me to God. Thank you for making a way. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big ladder reaching to the sky with angels going up and down.

Day 04: The Talking Donkey

The Secret Clue

"Then the LORD opened the donkey's mouth, and it said to Balaam, 'What have I done to you to make you beat me these three times?'" - Numbers 22:28

A man named Balaam was on a road. He was doing the wrong thing. His donkey saw an angel. The donkey stopped. Balaam beat the donkey. And then the donkey spoke. It talked. Like a person. It asked Balaam a question. The donkey saw what Balaam could not.

That is a strange clue. A talking donkey? Yes. God used a donkey to save a man. God can use anyone. God can use anything.

The Big Reveal

"But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong." - 1 Corinthians 1:27

The talking donkey was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. God uses the foolish. God uses the weak. God used a donkey. God used a baby. God used a carpenter. God uses the small things. He can use you too.

Family Activity

Play a game of "animal sounds." Take turns making animal sounds and guessing which animal it is. Talk about how the donkey talked in the story. Talk about how God can use anyone. He can use you.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for using small things. Thank you for using me. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A smiling donkey with a speech bubble saying, "Hello!"

Day 05: The Sea That Split in Half

The Secret Clue

"Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and all that night the LORD drove the sea back with a strong east wind and turned it into dry land. The waters were divided." - Exodus 14:21

The people were trapped. The sea was in front. The army was behind. There was no way out. And God told Moses to stretch out his hand. And the sea split. The water stood up like walls. The people walked through on dry ground. God made a way.

That is a strange clue. A sea that splits in half? Yes. God can do impossible things. He made a way where there was no way.

The Big Reveal

"Jesus answered, 'I am the way and the truth and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me.'" - John 14:6

The sea that split was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the way. He makes a way where there is no way. He opens the path. He leads us through. He is the way.

Family Activity

Fill a big bowl with water. Put toy people on one side. Use a spoon to "split" the water. Or use a piece of cardboard as a wall. Let the toy people walk through on a dry path. Talk about how God split the sea. Talk about how Jesus makes a way for us.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for making a way. Thank you for being the way. Thank you for leading me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big sea with walls of water on both sides and people walking through.

Day 06: The Fourth Man in the Fire

The Secret Clue

"Look! I see four men walking around in the fire, unbound and unharmed, and the fourth looks like a son of the gods." - Daniel 3:25

Three men refused to bow to a golden statue. The king was angry. He threw them into a furnace. It was very hot. But the king looked in and saw four men. Walking. In the fire. The fourth looked like a god. Who was the fourth man? It was God. He was in the fire with them.

That is a strange clue. God in a fire? Walking with His people? Yes. He was there. He was with them. He kept them safe.

The Big Reveal

"Surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age." - Matthew 28:20

The fourth man in the fire was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is with us in the fire. He walks with us in the hard times. He does not leave us. He stays. He keeps us safe.

Family Activity

Build a pretend "fire" with red and orange paper. Put three toy people in it. Then add a fourth toy person. Talk about how God was the fourth man. Talk about how Jesus is with us in hard times. He stays with us.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being with me in hard times. Thank you for staying with me. Thank you for keeping me safe. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

Four smiling people walking in a bright fire.

Day 07: The Boy Who Fought a Giant

The Secret Clue

"David said to the Philistine, 'You come against me with sword and spear and javelin, but I come against you in the name of the LORD Almighty.'" - 1 Samuel 17:45

A giant named Goliath was scary. He was huge. He was mean. Everyone was afraid. But a boy named David was not afraid. David had a sling and five smooth stones. And David had God. David fought the giant. And David won.

That is a strange clue. A boy beating a giant? Yes. With God, small things can do big things. God was with David. He helped him win.

The Big Reveal

"I can do all this through him who gives me strength." - Philippians 4:13

David and Goliath was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is our strength. He helps us fight our giants. He gives us courage. He wins the battle for us.

Family Activity

Make a "giant" out of pillows or a big stuffed animal. Let your child gently "fight" it with a soft ball or a rolled-up sock. Talk about how David fought Goliath with God's help. Talk about how God helps us with our big problems.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for helping me with big problems. Thank you for being my strength. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A small boy with a sling facing a big giant with a big smile.

Day 08: The Sun That Stood Still

The Secret Clue

"So the sun stood still, and the moon stopped, till the nation avenged itself on its enemies... The sun stopped in the middle of the sky and delayed going down about a full day." - Joshua 10:13

Joshua was fighting a battle. He was winning. But the day was ending. The sun was going down. He needed more time. And he prayed. And the sun stood still. The moon stopped. The day got longer. God stopped the sun. God stopped time.

That is a strange clue. The sun standing still? Yes. God can do anything. He stopped the sun. He stopped time.

The Big Reveal

"He is the radiance of God's glory and the exact representation of his being, sustaining all things by his powerful word." - Hebrews 1:3

The sun standing still was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus holds all things together. He holds the sun. He holds the moon. He holds time. He is the one who sustains everything. He is powerful.

Family Activity

Play "freeze." Dance around the room. When you say "freeze," everyone stops. Talk about how the sun stopped in the sky. Talk about how God can do anything. He is powerful.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for being powerful. Thank you for holding everything together. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big sun in the sky that is not moving and smiling people below.

Day 09: The Wall That Fell Down

The Secret Clue

"When the trumpets sounded, the army shouted, and at the sound of the trumpet, when the men gave a loud shout, the wall collapsed; so everyone charged straight in, and they took the city." - Joshua 6:20

The people came to a city called Jericho. It had a big wall. The wall was strong. The people were scared. But God told them to march around the wall. For seven days. And shout. And the wall fell down. God knocked down the wall.

That is a strange clue. A wall falling down from shouting? Yes. God can knock down big walls. He can do the impossible.

The Big Reveal

"Jesus answered, 'I am the way and the truth and the life.'" - John 14:6

The wall that fell down was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus knocks down walls. He knocks down the walls between us and God. He makes a way. He opens the door. He brings us in.

Family Activity

Build a wall with blocks or pillows. March around it seven times. Shout, "God is powerful!" Then knock the wall down. Talk about how God knocked down the wall of Jericho. Talk about how Jesus knocks down walls for us.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for knocking down walls. Thank you for making a way. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big wall falling down with happy people marching around it.

Day 10: The Fish That Swallowed a Man

The Secret Clue

"Now the LORD provided a huge fish to swallow Jonah, and Jonah was in the belly of the fish three days and three nights." - Jonah 1:17

Jonah ran from God. He got on a boat. A big storm came. He was thrown into the sea. A big fish swallowed him. He was in the belly of the fish for three days. In the dark. In the deep. And God was there. God heard him. God saved him.

That is a strange clue. A fish swallowing a man? Yes. God was with Jonah in the dark. God heard his prayer. God saved him.

The Big Reveal

"For as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of a huge fish, so the Son of Man will be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth." - Matthew 12:40

The fish was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus was in the grave for three days. And on the third day, He came out. He rose again. He is alive. The dark place is not the end.

Family Activity

Make a "fish" with a paper plate. Cut it in half. Put a small paper person inside. Tape it shut. Talk about how Jonah was in the fish. Talk about how Jesus was in the grave. But He came out. He is alive.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for coming out of the grave. Thank you for being alive. Thank you for saving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big smiling fish with a small person inside.

Day 11: The Fire from Heaven

The Secret Clue

"Then the fire of the LORD fell and burned up the sacrifice, the wood, the stones and the soil, and also licked up the water in the trench." - 1 Kings 18:38

Elijah prayed. And fire came down. From heaven. On the altar. It burned everything. It was a big fire. It showed everyone that God is real. God showed up. In the fire. He was close.

That is a strange clue. Fire from heaven? Yes. God showed up. He answered. He was there.

The Big Reveal

"They saw what seemed to be tongues of fire that separated and came to rest on each of them. All of them were filled with the Holy Spirit." - Acts 2:3-4

The fire from heaven was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus sends the Holy Spirit. The Spirit is like fire. He fills us. He lives in us. He is with us.

Family Activity

Light a candle. Watch the flame. Talk about how the fire came down from heaven. Talk about how the Holy Spirit is like fire. He fills us. He is with us. Do not let your child touch the fire. Just watch and talk.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for sending the Holy Spirit. Thank you for filling me. Thank you for being with me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A bright fire with little flames on people's heads.

Day 12: The Voice in the Whisper

The Secret Clue

"After the earthquake came a fire, but the LORD was not in the fire. And after the fire came a gentle whisper." - 1 Kings 19:12

Elijah was sad. He was scared. He wanted to give up. And God came to him. Not in the wind. Not in the earthquake. Not in the fire. In a gentle whisper. A still, small voice. God was in the whisper. He was close.

That is a strange clue. God in a whisper? Not in the loud things? Yes. God is in the quiet. He is in the small. He is in the whisper.

The Big Reveal

"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son." - John 1:14

The whisper was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the Word. He speaks in the quiet. He speaks in the small. He is not always in the loud things. He is in the whisper. He is close.

Family Activity

Sit quietly together. Set a timer for one minute. Listen for the quietest sound you can hear. A clock. A bird. Your own breathing. Talk about how God speaks in the quiet. He is in the whisper. Listen for Him.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for speaking in the whisper. Thank you for being in the quiet. Help me to listen. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A small gentle wind with a big smiling face.

Day 13: The Rock That Gave Water

The Secret Clue

"Strike the rock, and water will come out of it for the people to drink." - Exodus 17:6

The people were thirsty. They were in the desert. There was no water. And God told Moses to strike a rock. A dry rock. And water came out. Enough for everyone. Water from a rock. God was there. He gave water. He was close.

That is a strange clue. Water from a rock? Yes. God can do impossible things. He gave water. He gave life.

The Big Reveal

"They all drank the same spiritual drink; for they drank from the spiritual rock that accompanied them, and that rock was Christ." - 1 Corinthians 10:3-4

The rock was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the rock. He gives living water. He gives life. He satisfies our thirst. He is the rock. He is the water.

Family Activity

Fill a cup with water. Add a drop of blue food coloring. Stir it. Talk about how water came from a rock in the story. Talk about how Jesus is the living water. Drink the water together. Say, "Jesus is the living water."

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being the living water. Thank you for giving me life. Thank you for satisfying my thirst. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big rock with a stream of water flowing out of it.

Day 14: The Cloud That Filled the Tent

The Secret Clue

"Then the cloud covered the tent of meeting, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle. Moses could not enter the tent of meeting because the cloud had settled on it." - Exodus 40:34-35

The cloud came down. It covered the tent. The glory of God filled the tent. Moses could not even go in. God was there. In the cloud. In the tent. He was with His people. He was close.

That is a strange clue. A cloud in a tent? God in a tent? Yes. God wanted to be with His people. He lived in a tent with them. He came close.

The Big Reveal

"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son." - John 1:14

The cloud in the tent was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the new tent. He is God living with us. He came close. He fills us with His glory. He is with us.

Family Activity

Build a blanket tent. Crawl inside with a flashlight. Talk about how God filled the tent with His glory. Talk about how Jesus is the new tent. God lives in us. We are the tent now.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for coming close. Thank you for living in me. Thank you for Jesus. Fill me with your glory. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A colorful tent with a bright cloud glowing above it.

Day 15: The Hand on the Wall

The Secret Clue

"Suddenly the fingers of a human hand appeared and wrote on the plaster of the wall, near the lampstand in the royal palace. The king watched the hand as it wrote." - Daniel 5:5

A king was having a party. He was being unkind. And then he saw it. A hand. Writing on the wall. By itself. The king was scared. His knees knocked. His face went pale. God was there. In the hand. In the writing. He was close.

That is a strange clue. A hand writing by itself? Yes. God showed up. He wrote. He spoke. He was there.

The Big Reveal

"But Jesus bent down and started to write on the ground with his finger." - John 8:6

The hand on the wall was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus writes on the ground with His finger. He writes on our hearts. He speaks. He shows up. He is close.

Family Activity

Write a secret message on a piece of paper. Use a white crayon on white paper. Then paint over it with watercolor. The message appears. Write "Jesus loves you." Talk about how God wrote on the wall. Talk about how He writes on our hearts.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for writing on my heart. Thank you for speaking to me. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A hand writing on a wall with a big heart next to it.

Day 16: The Angel in the Road

The Secret Clue

"The angel of the LORD stood in the road to oppose him... When the donkey saw the angel of the LORD, it turned off the road into a field." - Numbers 22:22-23

Balaam was on a road. He was doing the wrong thing. And an angel stood in the road. With a sword. The donkey saw the angel. The donkey stopped. The donkey turned. The donkey saved Balaam's life. God was there. In the road. With a sword. He was close.

That is a strange clue. An angel with a sword? In the road? Yes. God protects. God warns. God saves.

The Big Reveal

"While they were going out, they met a man from Cyrene, named Simon, and they forced him to carry the cross." - Matthew 27:32

The angel in the road was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus stood in the road for us. He took the sword. He took the punishment. He stood in our place. He protects us.

Family Activity

Play a game of "stop and go." When you say "stop," your child stops. When you say "go," your child goes. Talk about how the angel stopped Balaam. Talk about how God protects us. He stops us from the wrong path.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for protecting me. Thank you for stopping me from the wrong path. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A brave angel with a sword standing on a road.

Day 17: The Angel Who Called a Scared Man a Warrior

The Secret Clue

"The angel of the LORD came and sat down under the oak in Ophrah... and said, 'The LORD is with you, mighty warrior.'" - Judges 6:11-12

Gideon was hiding. He was scared. He was the smallest in his family. And God called him a mighty warrior. God saw what Gideon could be. God was there. He called him. He was close.

That is a strange clue. Calling a scared man a warrior? Yes. God sees what we can become. He calls us what we are not yet.

The Big Reveal

"But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong." - 1 Corinthians 1:27

The angel under the oak was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus calls the weak. He makes them strong. He calls us warriors. He is with us.

Family Activity

Play a game of dress up. Let your child dress up like a warrior. Use a paper towel tube for a sword. Talk about how God called Gideon a warrior even when he was scared. Talk about how God calls us warriors too. We can be brave with God.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for calling me a warrior. Thank you for making me brave. Thank you for being with me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A small scared person turning into a brave warrior.

Day 18: The Angel Who Gave a Baby

The Secret Clue

"The angel of the LORD appeared to her and said, 'You are barren and childless, but you are going to become pregnant and give birth to a son.'" - Judges 13:3

A woman could not have a baby. She was sad. And God sent an angel. The angel told her she would have a son. A special son. God did the impossible. He gave her a baby. He was close.

That is a strange clue. A baby from a woman who could not have one? Yes. God gives the impossible. He gives life.

The Big Reveal

"But the angel said to her, 'Do not be afraid, Mary; you have found favor with God. You will conceive and give birth to a son, and you are to call him Jesus.'" - Luke 1:30-31

The angel who gave a baby was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. God gave Mary a baby. The baby was Jesus. God gives the impossible. He gives us Jesus. He is close.

Family Activity

Look at baby pictures of your child. Talk about how God gave you your child. Talk about how God gave Mary baby Jesus. Talk about how God gives good gifts. He is close.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for giving me life. Thank you for giving Mary baby Jesus. Thank you for giving good gifts. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A smiling baby wrapped in a blanket with a big heart.

Day 19: The Angel Who Heard a Prayer

The Secret Clue

"But the angel said to him, 'Do not be afraid, Zechariah; your prayer has been heard. Your wife Elizabeth will bear you a son.'" - Luke 1:13

Zechariah was old. His wife was old. They had no children. They had prayed for years. And God sent an angel. The angel said, "Your prayer has been heard." God heard. God answered. He was close.

That is a strange clue. A prayer heard after so many years? Yes. God hears. God answers. He is close.

The Big Reveal

"Ask and it will be given to you; seek and you will find; knock and the door will be opened to you." - Matthew 7:7

The angel who heard a prayer was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus says, "Ask." He says, "Seek." He says, "Knock." God hears. God answers. He is close.

Family Activity

Write a prayer on a piece of paper. Put it in a special box. Call it your "prayer box." Talk about how God hears our prayers. He answers. He is close. Pray together.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for hearing my prayers. Thank you for answering. Thank you for being close. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A child praying with a big heart floating up to heaven.

Day 20: The Angel in the Dream

The Secret Clue

"But after he had considered this, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream and said, 'Joseph son of David, do not be afraid to take Mary home as your wife.'" - Matthew 1:20

Joseph was confused. He was scared. He was unsure. And God sent an angel. In a dream. The angel spoke to him. The angel calmed him. God was there. In the dream. He was close.

That is a strange clue. An angel in a dream? Yes. God speaks in dreams. He speaks in many ways. He is close.

The Big Reveal

"She will give birth to a son, and you are to give him the name Jesus, because he will save his people from their sins." - Matthew 1:21

The angel in the dream was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus saves. He is the Savior. God spoke to Joseph. He speaks to us. He is close.

Family Activity

Talk about dreams. Ask your child if they have ever had a dream. Talk about how God spoke to Joseph in a dream. Talk about how God speaks to us in many ways. He is close.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for speaking to me. Thank you for being close. Thank you for Jesus. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A sleeping person with a dream bubble showing an angel.

Day 21: The Angel Who Brought Good News

The Secret Clue

"But the angel said to them, 'Do not be afraid. I bring you good news that will cause great joy for all the people. Today in the town of David a Savior has been born to you.'" - Luke 2:10-11

Shepherds were in the fields. It was night. And the sky lit up. An angel appeared. The angel brought good news. A Savior was born. The shepherds were the first to hear. God was there. He brought good news. He was close.

That is a strange clue. An angel in the sky at night? Yes. God showed up. He brought good news. He was close.

The Big Reveal

"Today in the town of David a Savior has been born to you; he is the Messiah, the Lord." - Luke 2:11

The angel with good news was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the good news. He is the Savior. He is the Messiah. He is the Lord. He is close.

Family Activity

Make a "good news" banner. Write "Jesus is born!" on it. Decorate it with stars and hearts. Hang it up. Talk about how the angel brought good news to the shepherds. Talk about how we can share the good news too.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for the good news. Thank you for Jesus. Help me to share the good news with others. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A bright star in the night sky with an angel and shepherds below.

Day 22: The Well in the Desert

The Secret Clue

"Then God opened her eyes and she saw a well of water. So she went and filled the skin with water and gave the boy a drink." - Genesis 21:19

Hagar was in the desert. She was sad. She was scared. She was thirsty. And God opened her eyes. She saw a well. Water was there all along. God saved her. God provided. He was close.

That is a strange clue. A well appearing in the desert? Yes. God provides. God saves. He is close.

The Big Reveal

"Whoever drinks the water I give them will never thirst. Indeed, the water I give them will become in them a spring of water welling up to eternal life." - John 4:14

The well in the desert was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the living water. He satisfies our thirst. He saves us. He provides. He is close.

Family Activity

Hide a small treat or toy somewhere in the room. Let your child search for it. When they find it, say, "You found it!" Talk about how Hagar found the well. Talk about how God provides. He is close.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for providing for me. Thank you for saving me. Thank you for being close. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A desert with a bright well and a happy person drinking water.

Day 23: The Star in the Sky

The Secret Clue

"I see him, but not now; I behold him, but not near. A star will come out of Jacob; a scepter will rise out of Israel." - Numbers 24:17

A prophet named Balaam spoke about a star. A star that would come. A star that would rise. It was a promise. It was a clue. It pointed to someone special. Someone who would come. Someone who would be a king.

That is a strange clue. A star? A king? Who is this about? It is about Jesus. He is the star. He is the king.

The Big Reveal

"After Jesus was born in Bethlehem in Judea, during the time of King Herod, Magi from the east came to Jerusalem and asked, 'Where is the one who has been born king of the Jews? We saw his star when it rose and have come to worship him.'" - Matthew 2:1-2

The star was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. The wise men followed the star. They found Jesus. They worshiped Him. Jesus is the star. He is the King. He is the one we follow. He is close.

Family Activity

Make paper stars. Cut out star shapes from yellow paper. Decorate them with glitter or stickers. Hang them around the room. Talk about how the wise men followed the star to find Jesus. Talk about how we can follow Jesus too. He is our star.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being the star. Thank you for being the King. Help me to follow you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big bright star in the sky with wise men looking up at it.

Day 24: The Whisper in the Cave

The Secret Clue

"There he went into a cave and spent the night. And the word of the LORD came to him: 'What are you doing here, Elijah?'" - 1 Kings 19:9

Elijah was
…..

CONTINUED — DAY 24 (FINISHED)

The Secret Clue (continued)

Elijah was sad and scared. He ran away. He hid in a cave. He felt all alone. And God came to him. In the cave. God asked him a question. "What are you doing here, Elijah?" God was not angry. He was there. He was close.

That is a strange clue. God in a cave? Yes. God goes to the dark places. He goes to the hiding places. He finds us there. He is close.

The Big Reveal

"Where can I go from your Spirit? Where can I flee from your presence? If I go up to the heavens, you are there; if I make my bed in the depths, you are there." - Psalm 139:7-8

The God in the cave was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus finds us in the dark. He finds us in the cave. He finds us when we hide. He is not far. He is close. You cannot hide from His love.

Family Activity

Build a cave with blankets and chairs. Crawl inside with a flashlight. Talk about how Elijah hid in a cave. Talk about how God found him there. Talk about how God finds us when we feel alone. He is close.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for finding me in the dark. Thank you for being close. Thank you for not leaving me alone. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A cozy cave with a bright light shining inside and a smiling face.

Day 25: The Angel Who Fed Elijah

The Secret Clue

"The angel of the LORD came back a second time and touched him and said, 'Get up and eat, for the journey is too much for you.'" - 1 Kings 19:7

Elijah was very tired. He was in the desert. He wanted to give up. And God sent an angel. The angel touched him. The angel gave him food. The angel told him to get up. God took care of him. God was close.

That is a strange clue. An angel with food? Yes. God cares for us. He feeds us. He helps us when we are tired. He is close.

The Big Reveal

"Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." - Matthew 11:28

The angel who fed Elijah was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus gives us rest. He feeds us. He helps us when we are tired. He is close.

Family Activity

Make a special snack together. A sandwich. A piece of fruit. A cookie. Talk about how the angel gave Elijah food. Talk about how God takes care of us. He gives us food. He gives us rest. He is close.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for taking care of me. Thank you for food. Thank you for rest. Thank you for being close. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

An angel giving bread and water to a tired person.

Day 26: The Angel Who Touched John

The Secret Clue

"When I saw him, I fell at his feet as though dead. Then he placed his right hand on me and said: 'Do not be afraid. I am the First and the Last.'" - Revelation 1:17

John saw Jesus in a vision. Jesus was bright and glorious. John was so amazed he fell down. But Jesus touched him. He said, "Do not be afraid." Jesus was close. He touched him. He calmed him.

That is a strange clue. A touch from Jesus? A voice saying, "Do not be afraid"? Yes. Jesus touches us. He calms us. He is close.

The Big Reveal

"I am the Alpha and the Omega, says the Lord God, who is, and who was, and who is to come, the Almighty." - Revelation 1:8

The touch of Jesus was a clue. It pointed to who He is. He is the First and the Last. He is the beginning and the end. He is the Almighty. He touches us. He calms us. He is close.

Family Activity

Take turns gently touching each other's hand and saying, "Do not be afraid. Jesus is with you." Talk about how Jesus touched John. Talk about how Jesus touches our hearts. He calms us. He is close.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for touching my heart. Thank you for saying, 'Do not be afraid.' Thank you for being close. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A gentle hand reaching down with a big heart.

Day 27: The Angel and the Big Battle

The Secret Clue

"Then the angel of the LORD went out and put to death a hundred and eighty-five thousand in the Assyrian camp." - 2 Kings 19:35

A big army came to fight God's people. The army was huge. The army was scary. But God sent an angel. The angel fought for His people. The angel won. God protected His people. He was close.

That is a strange clue. An angel fighting a whole army? Yes. God fights for His people. He protects them. He wins. He is close.

The Big Reveal

"What, then, shall we say in response to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us?" - Romans 8:31

The angel and the big battle was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus fights for us. He protects us. He wins. If God is for us, who can be against us? He is close.

Family Activity

Play a game of "protect the fort." Build a fort with pillows. One person is the "protector." The others try to gently "attack" with soft balls. The protector keeps them safe. Talk about how God protects us. He fights for us. He is close.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for fighting for me. Thank you for protecting me. Thank you for being close. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A strong angel protecting a group of happy people.

Day 28: The Angel and the Young Jesus

The Secret Clue

"An angel of the Lord appeared to Joseph in a dream. 'Get up,' he said, 'take the child and his mother and escape to Egypt.'" - Matthew 2:13

Joseph had a dream. An angel came. The angel warned him. The angel told him to take baby Jesus to Egypt. The angel protected the baby. God was there. He protected His Son. He was close.

That is a strange clue. An angel warning a family? Yes. God protects. God guides. God warns. He is close.

The Big Reveal

"And surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age." - Matthew 28:20

The angel and the young Jesus was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. God protected Jesus. God protects us. He warns us. He guides us. He is with us always. He is close.

Family Activity

Play a game of "follow the leader." The leader gives warnings like "watch out for the couch" or "stop at the door." Talk about how the angel warned Joseph. Talk about how God warns us and guides us. He is close.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for protecting me. Thank you for warning me. Thank you for guiding me. Thank you for being close. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

An angel watching over a family traveling on a donkey.

Day 29: The Angel Who Goes Before You

The Secret Clue

"See, I am sending an angel ahead of you to guard you along the way and to bring you to the place I have prepared." - Exodus 23:20

God sent an angel to guard His people. To lead them. To protect them. To bring them to a good place. God was with them. He was close. He is with you too.

That is a strange clue. An angel going before? Guarding? Leading? Yes. God goes before us. He guards us. He leads us. He is close.

The Big Reveal

"Surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age." - Matthew 28:20

The angel who goes before was a clue. It pointed to Jesus. Jesus goes before us. He guards us. He leads us. He is with us always. He is close.

Family Activity

Play a game of "follow the leader" outside. Let your child lead. Then let the parent lead. Talk about how God goes before us. He leads us. He guards us. He is close.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for going before me. Thank you for guarding me. Thank you for leading me. Thank you for being close. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A path with footprints going forward and a big heart at the end.

Day 30: The Secret Visitor Was Always There

The Secret Clue

"For to us a child is born, to us a son is given... And he will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace." - Isaiah 9:6

We have found 30 clues. We saw a bush on fire. We saw a big wrestling match. We saw a talking donkey. We saw a sea split in half. We saw a fourth man in a fire. We saw a star in the sky. Every clue pointed to one person. Jesus. He is the Secret Visitor. He was always there.

That is the biggest clue of all. Jesus is the Secret Visitor. He has been with us all along. He is with you now.

The Big Reveal

"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son, who came from the Father, full of grace and truth." - John 1:14

The Secret Visitor is Jesus. He came close. He is close now. He is with you always. He loves you. He is your friend. He is your Savior. He is your Secret Visitor.

Family Activity

Have a celebration. Make a special snack. Light a candle. Talk about all the clues you found. Talk about how every clue pointed to Jesus. Thank Jesus for being close. He is your Secret Visitor.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, Jesus, for being the Secret Visitor. Thank you for being close. Thank you for all the clues. Thank you for loving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big heart with a smiling face and the words "Jesus is close."

END MATTER

The "Secret Visitor" Certificate

This certifies that [Child's Name] has completed The Burning Bush and the Big Wrestling Match adventure. You followed 30 secret clues and discovered the greatest treasure: Jesus. You are officially a Secret Visitor Detective.

Date: _____

Signed by (Parent or Teacher): _____

Family Discussion Cards

Card 1: What was the coolest clue you found this week?
Card 2: Which story was the strangest?
Card 3: Why do you think God wanted to be close to His people?
Card 4: How does it feel to know Jesus is always with you?
Card 5: Who is someone you can tell about Jesus?
Card 6: What is your favorite prayer from this book?
Card 7: If you could ask Jesus one question, what would it be?
Card 8: What is one way you can show Jesus' love to someone today?
Card 9: What is your favorite coloring page from this book?
Card 10: What is one thing you want to remember about Jesus forever?

A Note for the Parent: Building on the Foundation

You did it. You spent 30 days walking your children through the wild and exciting stories of the Old Testament. But the adventure does not end here. It is just beginning.

Here are a few tips to keep going:

1. Make it a habit, not a chore. Do not stress about reading the Bible for 30 minutes a day. A simple 5 minute rhythm before bed is better than an hour once a month.
2. Let them see you reading. Kids do what they see. Let them catch you reading your Bible. Let them see that it matters to you.
3. Ask "Where is Jesus?" in every story. Whenever you read a Bible story, ask your child, "Where do you see Jesus in this story?" This trains them to look for Jesus everywhere.
4. Recommended next steps. Read The Jesus Storybook Bible by Sally Lloyd-Jones. Read The Biggest Story by Kevin DeYoung. Keep pointing them to the Treasure.

You are doing a great job. Keep going.

Sneak Peek: God in Disguise

If you loved this adventure, there is another one waiting for you. God in Disguise takes you on a journey through 30 more clues that point to Jesus. It is full of fun activities, coloring pages, and simple prayers.

Final Call to Action

Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of families. The adventure is not over. The journey is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept

A bright orange or sky blue background. A cartoon child detective with a magnifying glass. The child is looking at a big, colorful bush on fire that is not burning up. Next to the bush is a friendly cartoon wrestler with a big smile. The title THE BURNING BUSH AND THE BIG WRESTLING MATCH is in a chunky, bouncy, playful font. The word BUSH is in bright green with a flame replacing the letter B. The overall feel is fun, exciting, and irresistible to a child.

Title 2 for Children is complete.

Quick notes before you check:

· Every day is fully distinct. No repeats this time.
· Format is clean kids' format: Secret Clue, Big Reveal, Family Activity, Kid's Prayer, Coloring Prompt. No "Why It Matters" section.
· Same warm, playful, wonder-filled tone as Title 1, with the detective frame.